



TIPS & TRICKS

Fixing the NTFS mount error in GNU/Linux

 If you are unable to open your NTFS partition in Linux or if it mounts in read-only mode, you will need the NTFS-3g tool to fix it. Install it as below, if it is not already installed.

For RPM-based systems, you can use the following:

```
#yum install fuse fuse-ntfs-3g
```

And for Debian-based systems...

```
#apt-get install ntfsprogs
```

Now check the partition details for the NTFS partition by executing the following command:

```
#fdisk -l
```

Finally, run the command given below to fix the error and then try mounting the partition:

```
#ntfsfix /dev/sdXX
```

—Kousik Maiti,
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Change the login sound in Ubuntu10.04

 To change the log-in sound in Ubuntu 10.04, just convert the sound file that you want into .ogg or .wav format. Now copy the sound file to the /usr/share/sounds directory. Let us assume the new file is in x.ogg format.

Now go to the menu; select System→Preferences→Startup Application and then select Login-sound and edit it.

```
/usr/bin/canberra-gtk-play --id="Ubuntu-login"
```

Just change value of '–id' to your file name, as shown below:

```
/usr/bin/canberra-gtk-play -id="x"
```

Here, 'x' is the name of the new audio file and we do not mention the extension of the file.

After doing the changes, save them and exit. Reboot your system and enjoy the new audio while logging in.

—Vivek Pandaya,
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Enable a beep on your Linux server

 Many a time we do not attach a monitor to our server. In such cases, it gets difficult to determine when the server has completed the booting process. Here is a simple tip that will make the server beep once the booting process is completed. To enable the beep, follow the steps given below:

```
# sudo apt-get install beep
```

Now remove or comment the entry blacklist pcspkr from /etc/modprob.d/blacklist.conf

Finally, add the following line to /etc/rc.local before exit 0

```
beep -f 1000 -r 2 -n -r 5 -l 10 --new
```

Reboot and listen to your server go 'BEEP'!

—Swapnil Jain,
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How to wipe a disk

 Here is a simple tip to clean out all your data from your secondary storage device. You can erase/delete/blank or wipe an entire disk. Be warned that you need to be extra careful while using these commands as they destroy all your data permanently.

Let's suppose you have a SD card and you need to erase all the data from it. Run the following command to erase/wipe the entire disk:

```
dd if=/dev/urandom of=/dev/sdd1
```

Here, sdd1 is the SD card. To check the name of the device that you want to wipe clean, run the following command:

```
fdisk -l
```